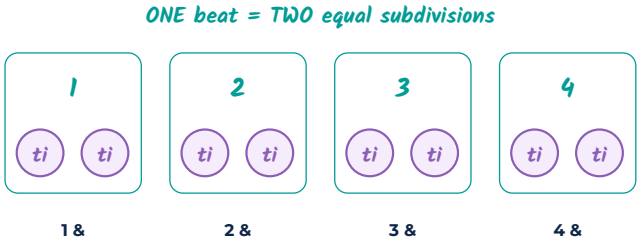
MODULE 05

Rhythm & Pulse

Keep the beat, place the rhythm, and use silence.



Find the Shared Pulse



Two Against the Beat

TEN ACTIVITIES IN THIS MODULE

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50 Rhythm Repair Loop

Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 041

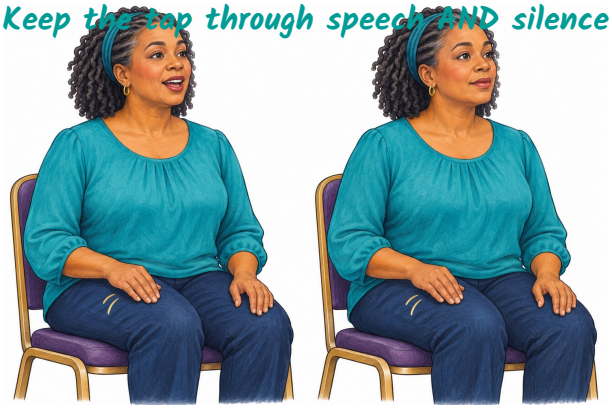
Find the Shared Pulse

Rhythm & Pulse

4 minutes / A short familiar song.

Establish a steady beat before working on rhythm.

Keep the tap through speech AND silence



tap	tap	tap	tap
1	2	3	4

The pulse continues through four silent beats, then the line returns in time.

1. *Tap a gentle beat on the legs while the director sings or speaks the opening line.*
2. *Continue tapping through four silent beats without changing speed.*
3. *Bring the line back and check whether the taps still match its underlying pulse.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The beat continues steadily during silence.

COMMON TRAP

Stopping the internal pulse during silence.

MAKE IT WORK

Use visible hand movements instead of tapping or let singers observe first.

ACTIVITY 042

Rhythm Echo Window

Rhythm & Pulse

5 minutes / Hands or a quiet tapping surface.

Copy a short rhythm after listening to its full shape.

MODEL / LISTEN

ta ta ti-ti ta



RESPONSE / ECHO

ta ta ti-ti ta

wait for cue

Hear the complete four-beat model before the response cue.

1. *Clap four beats containing 'ta ta ti-ti ta'; the choir listens until the full pattern ends.*
2. *Echo the whole pattern once, then compare exactly which beat held two sounds.*
3. *Try two new patterns, keeping the same four-beat listening window.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The response starts after the complete model and preserves its long and short sounds.

COMMON TRAP

Echoing before the complete model has finished.

MAKE IT WORK

Use spoken 'ta' instead of clapping or begin with two-beat patterns.

ACTIVITY 043

Speak, Tap, Sing

Rhythm & Pulse

6 minutes / Two bars from repertoire.

Separate a rhythm problem from its pitch problem.

SPEAK

Say the rhythm

TAP

Keep the beat in your hand

SING

Restore the melody

Keep the same pulse while changing one musical ingredient at a time.

1. Speak the syllable 'ta' in the passage's rhythm while tapping the underlying beat.
2. Speak the actual words with the same rhythm, checking where syllables share a beat.
3. Add the melody at a slower tempo, preserving the spoken rhythm.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Pitch does not make the learned rhythm disappear.

COMMON TRAP

Changing the tempo when adding melody.

MAKE IT WORK

Use only one bar until the coordination is dependable.

ACTIVITY 044

Rest Is an Action

Rhythm & Pulse

4 minutes / Four-beat pattern: sound, rest, sound, sound.

Count a silence actively and enter after it.

Then rest before another attempt

FOUR EVEN BEATS

1	2	3	4
ta	II REST	ta	ta
			
1	*keep counting*	*3*	*4*

Beat 2 is an action: open the hands silently and keep counting.

1

Clap on beats one, three, and four while opening the hands silently on beat two.

2

Repeat using 'loo' on a comfortable note; keep the rest silent rather than inhaling noisily on it.

3

Transfer the silent hand action to a rest in the repertoire.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The note after the rest arrives on time without an extra cue.

COMMON TRAP

Treating the rest as an empty extra beat.

MAKE IT WORK

Show four large beat cards and point to the rest.

ACTIVITY 045

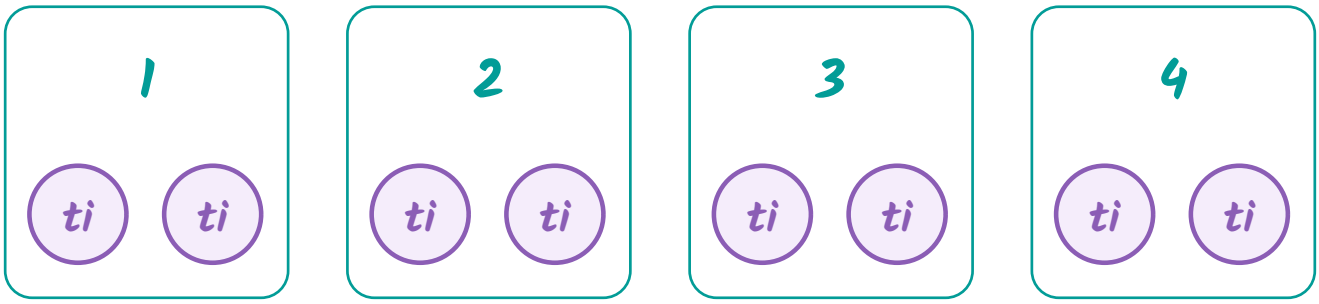
Two Against the Beat

Rhythm & Pulse

5 minutes / A steady moderate pulse.

Feel two equal subdivisions inside one steady beat.

ONE beat = TWO equal subdivisions



1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &

Two equal sounds inside each beat; the four large beats do not get faster.

1. *Tap four even beats with one hand and speak 'ti-ti' twice within each beat.*
2. *Alternate one sound per beat with two sounds per beat without changing the underlying tempo.*
3. *Speak a lyric passage that contains both note values, then add its pitches.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Paired sounds divide each beat evenly instead of accelerating.

COMMON TRAP

Speeding up the large beat when subdividing.

MAKE IT WORK

The director taps while the choir only speaks; combine actions later.

ACTIVITY 046

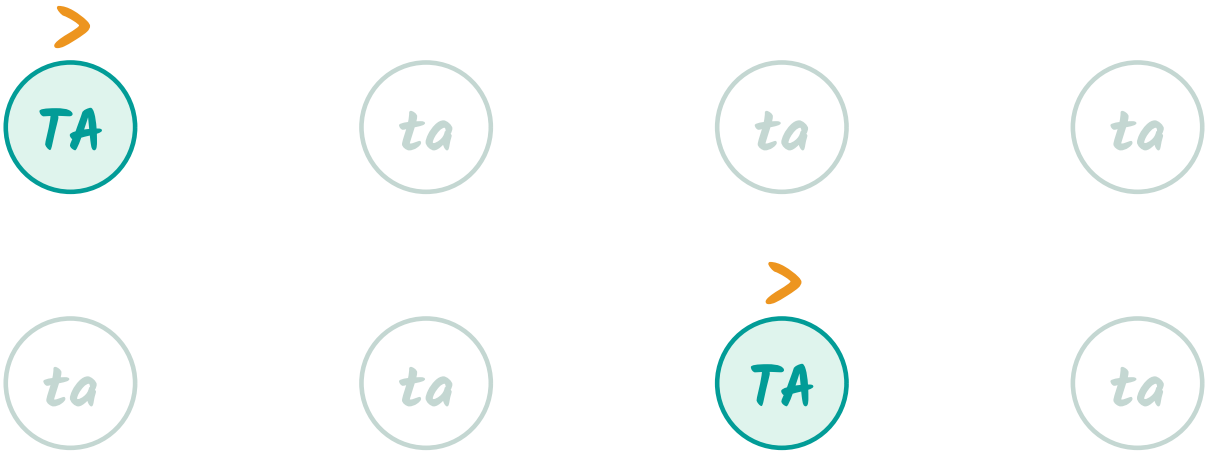
Accent Swap

Rhythm & Pulse

5 minutes / Four repeated spoken syllables.

Distinguish beat placement from musical emphasis.

Same tempo. A different emphasis.



Move the emphasis from beat 1 to beat 3 while keeping the spacing unchanged.

1

Speak four steady 'ta' syllables and gently emphasize the first without making it harsh.

2

Move the emphasis to beat three while keeping the beat equally spaced.

3

Find the accented word in a real phrase and practise it without speeding up toward it.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The emphasis changes while the tempo stays stable.

COMMON TRAP

Moving the beat itself with the emphasis.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a hand lift rather than a louder accent.

ACTIVITY 047

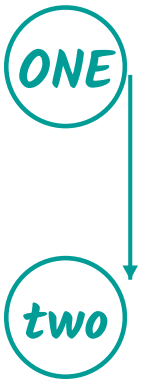
Walk the Meter

Rhythm & Pulse

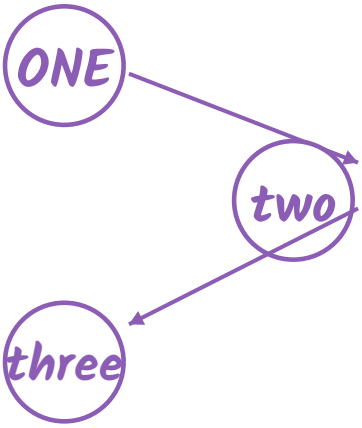
5 minutes / Seated hand movement or clear floor space.

Feel the difference between groups of two and three.

TWO-BEAT GROUP



THREE-BEAT GROUP



Two and three describe beat groupings. Keep every beat evenly spaced.

1. Move one hand down then up for a two-beat grouping while speaking 'ONE two'.
2. Change to down-side-up for 'ONE two three', keeping each beat evenly spaced.
3. Listen to two short musical examples from current repertoire and choose the matching gesture.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group identifies the grouping without confusing it with tempo.

COMMON TRAP

Confusing a different grouping with a faster tempo.

MAKE IT WORK

Use seated gestures only; walking is optional, never required.

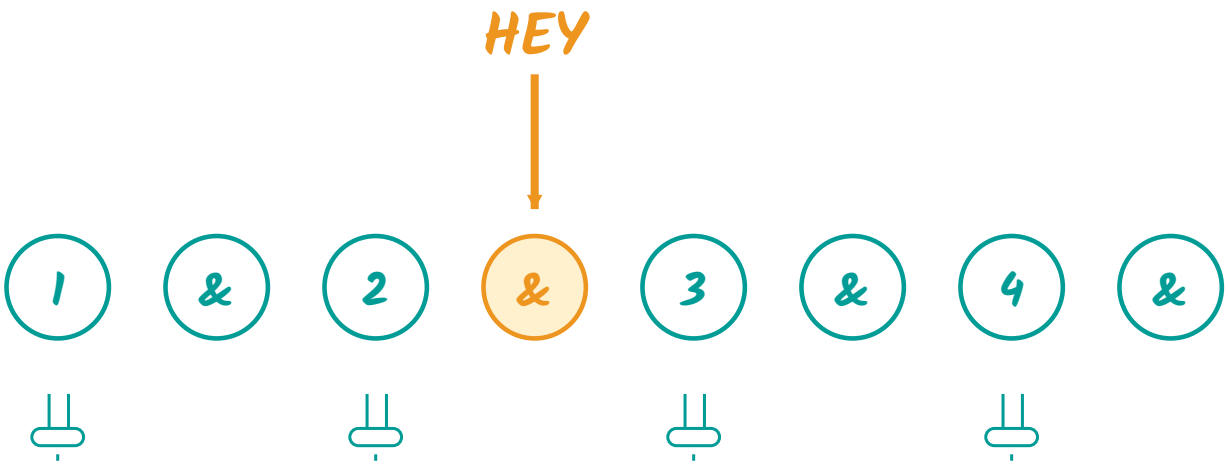
ACTIVITY 048

Offbeat Entry Builder

Rhythm & Pulse

6 minutes / Count '1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and'.

Enter accurately between two steady beats.



Count: 1 and 2 AND 3 and 4 and

Enter on the "and" AFTER beat 2, between the second and third taps.

1. *Tap each numbered beat while the director speaks every number and 'and'.*
2. *Say 'hey' only on the 'and' after beat two, keeping the beat in the hand.*
3. *Repeat with a gentle sung syllable, then apply the same entry point to the song.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir enters between beats instead of waiting for the next downbeat.

COMMON TRAP

Waiting for beat 3 instead of its preceding offbeat.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep the spoken count audible until the entrance is secure.

ACTIVITY 049

Tempo Keeper Relay

Rhythm & Pulse

6 minutes / Three willing leaders and a familiar rhythm.

Maintain tempo when leadership changes.

A / 8 BEATS

Keep the pulse

B / 8 BEATS

Take over in time

C / 8 BEATS

Keep the same pace

No gap at a handover. Each new leader inherits the same pace.

1. Leader A taps eight steady beats while everyone follows softly.
2. B takes over without a gap for the next eight, followed by C.
3. Repeat with the choir speaking a lyric and listen for speeding up at each handover.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The handovers preserve the original pace.

COMMON TRAP

Adding a pause when the leader changes.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a metronome only as an optional check, not as the leader.

ACTIVITY 050

Rhythm Repair Loop

Rhythm & Pulse

6 minutes / One trouble spot plus the beat before it.

Practise a difficult rhythm without restarting an entire song.



Isolate, rest, and repeat slowly; then reconnect both joins.

1. Locate the first point where the group loses agreement and isolate only that small section.
2. Loop it three times slowly with a clear starting count and a rest between attempts.
3. Reconnect it to the preceding and following bars; restore speed only after two accurate joins.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The transition remains accurate when surrounding music returns.

COMMON TRAP

Looping without a count-in or recovery gap.

MAKE IT WORK

Use spoken rhythm and remove pitches until the join works.